

WORKSHOP WHITEPAPER

Vibe *Design 101*

AI-Assisted Design in Practice

Yonsei University · Samsung Hall B-111

June 24, 2026 · 12 Participants · 3 Hours

SECTION 01

Workshop Overview

Vibe Design 101 was a hands-on workshop held at Yonsei University exploring how designers can work alongside a generative AI design agent — Google's Stitch — to produce high-quality UI designs. Twelve participants spent three hours discovering their personal design aesthetic, generating interfaces, and debating the evolving role of the designer in an AI-augmented workflow.

What We Did

1. Find Your Vibe. Rather than picking from a pre-made set, participants surfaced their preferred aesthetic — their "vibe" — through a self-introduction exercise, sharing and identifying the styles they naturally gravitated toward. This step proved to be the single biggest predictor of downstream output quality.
2. Generate with Stitch. Participants used Stitch (Google's Design AI Agent) to generate interfaces over two rounds. Round one relied on text prompts alone — defining Idea, Contents, and Theme in words — which made the limits of text-only input clear and surfaced the importance of input context. Round two generated from reference images plus a DESIGN.md, letting participants feel exactly which parts of the input context to fill in to reach the design they had in mind.
3. Reflect Together. The session closed with a discussion of what the agent did well, what it struggled with and why, and what the designer's role becomes in the future this technology points toward.

SECTION 02

What We Noticed

Working hands-on with the agent surfaced a few practical observations. These aren't final conclusions — just what stood out to us while generating.

TEXT ALONE RARELY LANDS THE DESIGN

In round one we drove generation with text prompts only — Idea, Contents, and Theme described in words. The outputs kept drifting from what we had in mind. The limiting factor wasn't prompt cleverness; it was the thinness of the input context we gave the agent.

REFERENCE IMAGES + A DESIGN.md CLOSE THE GAP

Round two paired visual references with a structured DESIGN.md. With richer input context, outputs moved noticeably closer to intent — and it became clear which parts of that context (mood, layout, type, color) most needed to be spelled out.

THE AGENT'S STRENGTHS AND BLIND SPOTS ARE UNEVEN

Stitch handled complex composition with ease, yet sometimes stumbled on seemingly trivial requests (e.g., applying a solid-color background). A useful reminder to review outputs critically rather than assume difficulty maps to what feels hard for a human.

SECTION 03

The Designer's Role in the AI Era

One of the workshop's most energising segments asked a single question: if AI can now handle execution, what remains distinctly human in the design process? Three themes emerged consistently across the group.

Intent

AI executes; humans set direction. The designer's first job is to know what they want — a skill that cannot be outsourced. Participants with clear design intent moved through the workflow faster and with better results.

Judgment

AI generates options; designers choose. Evaluating output quality, recognising when the agent has missed the mark, and course-correcting is a core skill that becomes more valuable, not less, as generation gets cheaper.

Taste

Taste is the hardest thing to replicate. A designer's personal aesthetic — their vibe — is the fingerprint that differentiates their work. Participants who could articulate their taste produced output that felt coherent and intentional.

"Just as Vibe Coders emerged from AI-assisted coding, the age of the Vibe Designer is here."

SECTION 03

In Their Words

How participants described the same shift, in their own reflections at the close of the session.

"Human taste plus the fresh ideas AI throws out — together they could bring real energy to the work."

"I felt that, as a designer, the ability to plan and architect carefully is exactly what's needed."

"Just as open-source ecosystems drove software forward, we now need an ecosystem where design best practices for working with AI agents are openly shared."

"Setting design direction from references — and seeing how the same AI gives dramatically different results depending on the prompt — made me realise a designer isn't someone who just makes pretty screens, but someone whose ability to clearly communicate the mood and concept they want is what matters."

SECTION 04

Takeaways & What's Next

The workshop validated several hypotheses and surfaced new ones. We split the closing notes into practical tips for the next session and open questions for design education.

Key Takeaways — Practical Tips

USE REFERENCES + A DESIGN.md

Don't rely on text prompts alone. Pair visual references with a structured DESIGN.md to give the agent the input context it needs.

VIBE FIRST, GENERATE SECOND

Front-load design intent. A few minutes clarifying aesthetic preferences saves significant iteration time downstream.

VERIFY THE SIMPLE STUFF

AI agents excel at complex composition but can stumble on trivial requests. Always review outputs critically.

What's Next — Design Education in the AI Era

TEACH TASTE ALONGSIDE TOOLS

Design education should invest in developing students' aesthetic judgment — what AI cannot replicate and what employers will value most.

BUILD A SHARED BEST-PRACTICE ECOSYSTEM

As open source advanced software, the field needs openly circulated best practices for designing with AI agents.

CULTIVATE INTENT & COMMUNICATION

Train designers to articulate the mood and concept they want; clear direction is becoming the core skill.

"Even in the age of AI, your taste and judgment remain your greatest asset. Hold onto the vibe you found today."